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MNR drafts new lake trout proposal

Two options discussed with resource users

By Marjell Ennis,
Gazette reporter

Fishermen in Lanark County and the rest of Eastern Ontario will be enjoying their sport under more stringent regulations once the ministry of natural resources settles on a new program for regulating the taking of lake trout.

An estimated 40 organizations, including the Almonte Fish and Game Association, cottage groups and tourist operators met with ministry officials recently to discuss a new management approach which will protect the native lake trout population and ensure its perpetuation.

Three sets of three similar meetings were held during January, April, and December of 1985 in Cloyne, Smiths Falls, and Kingston. The meetings were held to gain feedback from the various resource users identifying what should be done to protect the trout population.

There was definite support for the development of a lake trout management strategy and concern over resource status, said Carleton Place branch ministry management officer Hans von Rosen.

The draft report which was drawn up from this information says the areas bounded by the administrative boundaries of Eastern Ontario once contained 62 native lake trout lakes. This number has dwindled to 46, of which only 29 show signs of significant natural reproduction.

Since lake trout habitat can be seriously affected by various land or water uses, the report suggests ministry participation in planning activities to encourage municipalities to declare specific areas of concern around lake trout lakes, with emphasis on road construction, subdivi-

sion, severances, etc."

Also suggested was a liaison with the ministry of agriculture and food and respective municipalities in an advisory capacity on the construction on municipal drains on water courses which empty into lake trout lakes.

The stocking of lake trout has been a traditional management approach. However, hatchery-reared fish may possess a different genetic makeup and if these are mixed with wild fish, "the resulting progeny could have a jeopardized survival value," the report said. Lake trout stocking will be replaced with splake (speckled trout and lake trout cross) stocking on lakes currently being managed. This cross breed type do not reproduce.

Brook trout and rainbow trout stocking will also continue.

In terms of harvest control, "... the challenge is to design regulatory schemes that allow for maximum recreation and do not exclude any participants while still maintaining the biological objectives for sound resource management."

The ministry, with the help of those organizations participating in the series of meetings, has arrived at two possible options for new lake trout and splake angling regulations.

Almonte Fish and Game Association president Bill Tuffin said the ministry has supposedly incorporated 65 per cent of the suggestion put forth by these organizations.

The first option and the one, according to Mr. von Rosen, favored by the ministry, maintains the use of the tag and quota system, and keeps the winter fishing season open.

The quota system will not permit the possession of any untagged lake trout on regulated lake trout lakes.

If the use of tags and the quota

system is unattractive to fishermen, then they have the option to angle for trout in Division 29 where the restrictions would not apply and where lakes are capable of accepting the added harvest pressure. The splake fishery would provide winter fishing with more liberalized creel limits.

Division 29 is that area west of the Lanark and Frontenac County line north of Hwy 7, and includes the northern portion of Lennox and Addington.

Option 2 has omitted the quota-tag system. As a result, in order to "meet biological objectives," the winter lake trout season in Divisions 9 and 10 has been excluded.

This area includes the southern portion of Lennox and Addington, Frontenac, all of Lanark, and all of Leeds. Division 9 also runs north into Renfrew County.

Fishermen would have the option of travelling to Division 29 to enjoy lake trout angling.

The winter closure on lake trout would exist south of Hwy 7, although winter seasons would exist in the north and designated splake lakes in the south.

Mr. Tuffin expressed the concern that if option 2 is selected as policy, Division 29 will be overwhelmed with a heavy angling burden.

He said "something tough has to be done to protect the lake trout or, in time, there will be no lake trout fishing available. I'd rather be tough on regulations and see it (lake trout fishing) maintained rather than be destroyed by lenient laws."

Mr. von Rosen said the ministry is definitely proposing the option maintaining the use of tags. As yet there has been no official decision reached.

Carleton County farm organizations announce slate of meetings for 1986

The new year brings with it a number of farm organizations' annual meetings, and Carleton County is no exception.

The Carleton Soil and Crop Improvement Association annual meeting is slated for Tuesday, Jan 7th at 10:30 am in the Richmond Community Centre.

Then, on Wednesday, Jan 22nd at 10:30 am, the Soil and Crop Improvement Association is co-sponsoring

a "Field Crops Technical Day" with the Carleton Corn Producers' Association. Dr. Terry Daynard, secretary-treasurer of the Ontario Corn Producers' Association will be guest speaker.

Dorothy Haley, Soils and Crop Specialist, Ontario Ministry of Agriculture and Food, will conduct an in-depth discussion and analysis of 1985 Field Day Projects; and the corn producers will hold an election of executive. This meeting is planned for the Stittsville Community

Centre.

The Carleton Beef Improvement Club's annual meeting is at the Richmond Community Centre on Wednesday, Jan 8th at 8 pm. Geoff Young, agricultural representative for Renfrew County will be speaking on "Feeding the Beef Cow."

Gerhard Schickendanz, president, Ontario Cattlemen's Association will be speaking at the Carleton-Grenville Cattlemen's annual meeting on Monday, Jan

13th at 8 pm at the Richmond Community Centre.

Other annual meetings planned include the Carleton Pork Producers' on Wednesday, Feb 5th at the agricultural office, Nepean at 8 pm; and the Eastern Breeders Inc., Carleton annual at 11 am on Thursday, Feb 6th at Gerry's Dining Lounge.

Please mark these dates on your calendar and plan to attend.

ALMONTE GENERAL HOSPITAL

wishes to extend to all our friends, a very Happy Holiday Season. We wish to thank all who participated in our annual Christmas Bazaar. Your contributions and support are greatly appreciated by patients and staff.

We are happy to announce the winners of our Christmas raffle.

1st PRIZE: Afghan and Matching Pillow (donated by Mrs. Lorraine Kilborne) — Mrs. Helen Pragnell

2nd PRIZE: Chair Bear (donated by Mrs. Loretta Scott) — Mrs. Leslie D. Carroll

3rd PRIZE: Christmas Cake (donated by Mrs. Mary Thurston) — Mrs. Dallas O'Connor.

4th PRIZE: Cheese Basket (donated by Mrs. Elsie McIsaac) — Mrs. Mary Turner

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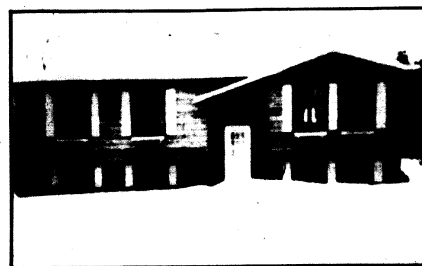
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